

me'. I believe this quote rings so true when we think about so many of our Money Stories.

When you start to dig out your own patterns, stories and behaviours, I want you to think about what 'lie' might be hidden in your own Money Story. Can you find the piece that's not right for you? Maybe it's a Money Story about the importance of owning your own home but you know that story isn't quite right for you because you want the freedom to chase a job around the globe or because you've discovered the FIRE movement (Financial Independence, Retire Early, which is all about aggressively saving while you minimise your expenses—we'll look at this more in Part Three). Money Story about financial recklessness and even addictive behaviours where you haven't realised you've unconsciously picked up similar money compulsions. Maybe it's that 'smart girls' should choose a sensible profession over the creative industries. Maybe it's that a man should be the main breadwinner. Maybe it's about what you think you should be doing or where you think you should be at your stage of life or age. Or maybe, like me, it's about the story of not being enough.

Now it's your turn. Because I don't want this to be a book full of theories, I want you to take action. The following exercises and questions will help you start with this process of recognising your Money Story and possibly rewriting your own brave new ending:

The Money Stories you grew up with might be very different from the Money Story you hold today but it's important to recognise what they were so you can understand whether they're still influencing you negatively or positively as an adult. Take a moment to reflect on your childhood money memories—whether they were observations from your parents, your family, your peers, your siblings, your teachers, your church, your culture, your community, or society in general. It might be lessons, values, how your parents behaved individually with money, whether there was stress and worry around money and so much more. Then answer the following questions:

- What Money Stories did I learn from my parents, my peers, the media and those around me?